

Tempeh buckwheat shepherd's pie

The secret to this savory pie lies in the trio of tempeh, buckwheat, and portobello mushrooms—**artfully** combined with a variety of flavorings. The result is an original, delicious, substantial meal in a dish. Made ahead, the tempeh filling will taste even better as the flavors combine.

¼ cup toasted buckwheat [60g]

3 large shallots, minced

2½ tablespoons olive oil

1 package (8 ounces) tempeh, shredded or crumbled [250g]

2 medium carrots, peeled and finely diced

1 celery rib, finely diced

2 garlic cloves, minced

1 large portobello mushroom, cut into ½-inch [1-cm] dice

½ teaspoon dried sage

½ teaspoon dried thyme

½ teaspoon dried oregano

½ teaspoon dried rosemary

2 cups vegetable stock or red wine [500ml]

1 tablespoon tomato paste

2 teaspoons barley miso or red miso

1 tablespoon molasses or maple syrup

1 tablespoon red wine vinegar

2 teaspoons soy sauce

2 teaspoons vegetarian Worcestershire sauce

2 teaspoons nutritional yeast powder

1 teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon freshly ground pepper

Mustard Mashed Potato Topping (recipe follows)

1. **Preheat** the oven to 375°F [190°C]. In a small saucepan, bring ¾ cup [150ml] water to a boil. Stir in the buckwheat, reduce the heat to medium-low, and cook, stirring occasionally, until just tender, about 10 minutes. Buckwheat cooks very quickly, so keep an eye on it.
2. In a large skillet, **cook** the shallots in 2 tablespoons of the olive oil over medium-low heat until softened and lightly browned, about 3 minutes. Add the tempeh, carrots, celery, garlic, and mushroom. Increase the heat slightly and cook for about 5

minutes, stirring frequently. Add the sage, thyme, oregano, and rosemary. Cook and stir for another minute, until very fragrant. When the mixture begins to stick slightly to the bottom of the pan, turn up the heat and pour in the vegetable stock or wine. Stir in the tomato paste. Bring to a boil and cook until the liquid reduces and the mixture thickens, 3 to 5 minutes.

3. Stir in the miso, molasses, vinegar, soy sauce, Worcestershire sauce, nutritional yeast, salt, pepper, and cooked buckwheat. **Spoon** into 4 individual gratin dishes or other ovenproof containers. Spread the mashed potato topping over the tempeh mixture and press down firmly. Brush with the remaining olive oil.
4. **Bake** for 5 to 10 minutes, until the potatoes are just a touch browned on top.

SERVES 4

Mustard mashed potato topping

3 pounds baking potatoes [1.5kg]

1 to 2 tablespoons Dijon mustard, or to taste

1 cup [250ml] plain yogurt, preferably organic, or ½ cup [125ml] plain soy milk or rice milk

1 teaspoon salt

Freshly ground pepper

1. **Peel** the potatoes and cut into large chunks. Cook in a large saucepan of salted boiling water until soft, 10 to 12 minutes; drain. Pass the potatoes through a ricer or mash with a potato masher until smooth.
2. Add the yogurt or soy milk and mustard to the mashed potatoes and **blend** very well. Season with the salt and a generous grinding of pepper.

MAKES ABOUT 4 CUPS [1ML]